metrics

459 million

The approximate number of people worldwide with Internet access

Indian households with multiple PCs

5 per cent

Source: www.nasscom.org

tomorrowstechnology

Scientists make transistor one-molecule thick

Scientists have developed a transistor which contains only one active molecule. This is something that will one day turn current technology on its head.

The goal for miniaturisation has taken a tremendous step forward and the possibilities for this technology are utterly limitless.

As we shrink the size of technology and its applications, we are able to achieve feats previously unheard of. Aside from the advantages of portable technology, for areas like medicinal research, this form of nanotechnology is the Holy Grail of progress.

Surfs up, dude! WAAAY up!

If you surf, you know what it's like to find that oh- so-perfect wave. What if you were told that it's now possible to use technology to make the one you want?

No, for a change we are not talking about surfing on the World Wide Web. It's more real-world than that.

After closely studying different waves across the world, scientists have been able to create artificial reefs that control waves and adjust them to a particular preference.

Using large sandbags (about 20 metres long and weighing 300 tons) and placing them with the help of a satellite-based global positioning system (GPS), these reefs can be custom designed to change the speed and size of the wave.

Bugged DVDs

So you think the Internet and pirated software are the only ways to catch a virus on your PC? Even those who purchase software might be at risk—if you're a fan of the Powderpuff Girls, that is. Warner Brothers confirmed that the DVD titled *Meet the Alls* packs an added 'bonus' called the FunLove virus.

Though rare, such incidences catch users who trust purchased software off-guard and thus makes them prone to virus attacks.

Think about Microsoft's dilemma when users of their on-line tech support got infected.

Who is?

Douglas E. Van Houweling

▲ *Who is he?*

He is president and CEO of the University Corporation of Advanced Internet Development (UCAID), which is spearheading the Internet2 project.

▲ *Why Internet2?*

Douglas and the cause of Internet2 believe in designing a network from the ground up which will move data faster than today's Internet. The applications to consume a new pool of bandwidth would predominantly be audio and video, the two aspects of data that are hungry for bandwidth. So far, HDTV programs have successfully been transferred over Internet2.

▲ *Increased Security?*

Developing an infrastructure from the ground up allows developers to correct any and all flaws. The UCAID is analysing current security flaws of the Internet and developing a better infrastructure to make Internet2 more secure.

A degree in computer fashion

Does a degree in Wearable Computing sound like something straight out of science fiction? It is more real that you think. The Graz University of Technology in Austria claims to offer the first series of programmes that offers degrees at the undergrad, graduate and post-graduate levels. If it sounds like a total pushover, it isn't. Students also run through typical subjects such as computation, physics, electronics and math.

There is no doubt that wearable computing is the next big trend in technology and this course may give you the opportunity to be a guru by the time its expertise is needed.

◆ ATi A3 Athlon XP chipset revealed ◆ Windows XP causes Intel mobile chips to overheat ◆ Palm to replace buggy devices